

THE PROOF SHEET

Written by

A. N. Placeholder

INT. ARCHIVE BASEMENT - NIGHT

Steel shelving to the ceiling. A single bulb, swinging.

EXT. LOADING DOCK - CONTINUOUS

Rain on corrugated tin, loud enough to argue over.

INT./EXT. DELIVERY VAN - MOVING - LATER

The wipers lose.

42 INT. ARCHIVE BASEMENT - RESHELVING - DAY 42

A dual-margin scene number, the shooting-script shape: the same number printed at both margins.

INT. READING ROOM - DAY

ODILE sets down a box that is heavier than it looks.

INDEX CARDS

Handwriting from four decades, none of it consistent.

LEDGER, LATER

One column, ruled in pencil, never once balanced.

CUT TO:

INT. STAIRWELL - CONTINUOUS

Footsteps going down two at a time.

DISSOLVE TO:

EXT. ARCHIVE - NIGHT

The building keeps its lights on for nobody.

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. ARCHIVE BASEMENT - NIGHT

Nobody is where their voice says they are.

BUNNY

(O.S.)

The period-full spelling, the one
the manuals print.

CASSIUS

(V.O)

And the one writers actually type,
missing its period.

ODILE

(O.C)

Off camera, also missing its
period.

WREN (CONT'D)

A continued cue, carrying its
extension.

DR. E. T. MARCHETTI

Dotted abbreviations sitting inside
a character name.

BUNNY (V.O.)

A hybrid: name and extension on one
cue line.

INT. READING ROOM - DAY

The box is open now. It was not worth the trip.

BUNNY

(quietly)

A leading parenthetical, before a
word is spoken.

CASSIUS

A line, and then a beat in the
middle of it.

(reconsidering)

And then the rest of it, after the
beat.

ODILE

(standing)

(then, to WREN)

Two stacked parentheticals before
any dialogue at all.

WREN

Short.

INT. ARCHIVE BASEMENT - NIGHT

They have been at this for six hours.

No. WREN

Yes. BUNNY

No. WREN

ODILE

MORE-ANCHOR. This speech begins near the foot of the page on purpose, so that it runs over the break and has to be put back together on the other side. It keeps going well past the boundary so the rejoin has something substantial to work with, and so that the same speech doubles as the long-dialogue case the coverage

table asks for, rather than
spending two constructions on what
is really one shape.

INT. CONSERVATION BENCH - DAY

The label reads **DO NOT LAMINATE**, twice.

She says it *again*, and this time somebody writes it down.

The stamp is ***both bold and italic*** at once.

A styled run that **crosses the wrap boundary because it keeps going for long enough to need a second line**, and then stops.

Punctuation only, styled by itself.

This word is underlined with drawn vector art.

This phrase is ~~struck-through~~, above the baseline.

A table rules a border below this cell, further down.

A page-wide rule crosses this whole line of text.

CHYRON: EVERY NAME HERE IS INVENTED.

A footnote, set smaller than the body.

The index card, enlarged for the reader.

A SIGN, VERY LARGE INDEED

WREN

A text message, in the phone's own face.

CASSIUS

Dialogue can be **bold** too.

ODILE

And *italic*, which is the common one.

INT. READING ROOM - DAY

They speak over each other.

BUNNY
LEFTMARK. Short, on the
left.

CASSIUS
RIGHTMARK. Short, on the
right.

And again, at length.

ODILE
This column runs long
enough that the taller of
the two passes twelve
estimated rendered lines,
which is the threshold
where the side-by-side
table gives up and both
speeches become ordinary
sequential dialogue
instead.

WREN
And this one answers at
similar length so neither
column is trivially short,
because the fallback
measures the taller of the
pair and a stub would
never reach it.

BUNNY

Speech one. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech two. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech three. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech four. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech five. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech six. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech seven. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech eight. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech nine. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech ten. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech eleven. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech twelve. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech thirteen. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech fourteen. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech fifteen. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech sixteen. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech seventeen. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech eighteen. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech nineteen. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the

bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech twenty. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech twenty-one. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech twenty-two. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech twenty-three. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech twenty-four. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech twenty-five. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech twenty-six. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech twenty-seven. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech twenty-eight. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom

of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech twenty-nine. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech thirty. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech thirty-one. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech thirty-two. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech thirty-three. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech thirty-four. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech thirty-five. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech thirty-six. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

BUNNY

Speech thirty-seven. Short.

CASSIUS

Speech thirty-eight. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

ODILE

Speech thirty-nine. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.

WREN

Speech forty. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed. If this line sits alone at the top or the bottom of a page, the keep failed.